SOP- LEARNING & DEVELOPMENT

[CONFIDENTIAL]
[UTTHUNGA]
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CHANGE HISTORY

This section describes the details of changes that have resulted in the current document.

SL. No.	Document Version No.	Change Description	Reason For change	Date Prepared By	Date Reviewed By	Date Approved By
01	Issue B Version 1.0	Revised the document to suit the requirements for implementation of the integrated management system	Implementation of the Integrated Management System	Kavitha Pradeep 01/03/2023	Amulya MS 05/03/2023	Anitha 09/03/2023
02	Issue B Version 1.1	Concise the SOP as per the L&D operations flow and cover the consequential scenarios for clarity on actions.	Added templates for the reports, mails, and forms. Added actions taken on deviation on SOP.	Gayathri Kasinathan 9/08/2024	Tony Pillai 9/08/2024	Anitha 09/08/2024
03	Issue B Version 1.2	Define significant process followed by L&D in the Induction process. Basic etiquettes, compliance trainings for new joiners. frequency and period have been updated.	Appropriate frequency and protocol followed by L&D had to be updated	Gayathri Kasinathan 4/03/2025	Karthik Basavaraju 4/03/2025	
04	Issue B Version 1.3	Risk assessment frequency has been updated too	As request from L&D was accepted by PE	Gayathri Kasinathan 4/03/2025	Karthik Basavaraju 4/03/2025	
05	Issue B Version 1.3	Employee registration process to take part in training.	Employees to be held accountable for participation in training	Gayathri Kasinathan 4/03/2025	Karthik Basavaraju 4/03/2025	
06	Issue B Version 1.3	Additional Compliance training has been added in 9.1.2 section	Additional mandatory trainings to align with corporate policy	Gayathri Kasinathan 4/03/2025	Karthik Basavaraju 4/03/2025	
07	Issue B Version 1.3	Revamped templates	Templates to contain objectives	Gayathri Kasinathan	Karthik Basavaraju	Karthik Basavaraju 4/03/2025

				4/03/2025	4/03/2025	
08	Issue B Version 1.4	Certifications	To ensure better tracking of certified employees, control certification-related costs, and enforce bond agreements effectively.	Gayathri Kasinathan 11/07/2025	Karthik Basavaraju 11/07/2025	
09	Issue B Version 1.4	Defaulters and last-minute drop out and exit from training	To minimize training resource wastage and improve planning accuracy by reducing last-minute cancellations and non-participation.	Gayathri Kasinathan 11/07/2025	Karthik Basavaraju 11/07/2025	
10	Issue B Version 1.4	Clearance from L&D	To ensure cost recovery and accountability for training investments before employee exits the organization.	Gayathri Kasinathan 11/07/2025	Karthik Basavaraju 11/07/2025	
11	Issue B Version 1.4	Procurement process changes	To streamline vendor engagement, enhance transparency, and improve turnaround time in procurement workflows.	Gayathri Kasinathan 11/07/2025	Karthik Basavaraju 11/07/2025	Karthik Basavaraju 11/07/2025
12	Issue C Version 1.0	Review of document	New version update of IMS	Anitha N 01-08-2025	Santosh V 08-Aug-25	Sanmangala M S 14-08-2025

1 Purpose

a. The purpose of this document is to define the process of conducting and maintaining training records in the organization across all locations and regions of Utthunga.
b. To define procedures to identify and meet the Learning needs in the organization.
c. Facilitate employees in acquiring required skills, knowledge, and attitude for achieving the individual, team, and organization goals.
d. Understanding all the procedures the employees must follow for all learning and development activities in the organization.
e. Training Metrics and maintenance of learning records and assets
f. Analysis of learning programs and their business outcomes.

2 Scope

The scope of this document applies to all the Learning activities in Utthunga to all the employees across all locations/ geographies of Utthunga. Note: Interns and consultants are not in scope of this procedure.

3 Abbreviations

a. HRD: Human Resource Director

b. L&DH: Learning & Development Head

c. TRF: Training Requisition Form

d. L&D: Learning and Development

e. SME: Subject Matter Expert

f. BUH: BU- Head

g. ILT: Instructor lead Training

h. TNA: Training need Analysis

4 Terms and Definitions

a. TNA – Systematic process used by the organization to identify the gap between current skills, knowledge, and abilities of their employees with the skills required to meet the organizational goals.

b. New Skill addition - Acquiring and developing additional skills that an individual did not possess previously. It could involve learning something entirely new or enhancing existing skills.

c. Organizational credibility upgrade - Efforts made by an organization to enhance and strengthen its credibility in the eyes of its stakeholders, including employees, customers, investors, partners, and the public.

d. Internal Training - Gives an opportunity to employees to enhance their skills, capabilities, and knowledge to perform their job effectively. This training is provided by the In-House SME for the employees.

e. External Training - Gives an opportunity to employees to enhance their skills, capabilities, and knowledge to perform their job effectively. This training is provided to employees by sources (Training institute/vendors) outside of the organization.

f. Web based learning - This is also known as E-Learning which allows individuals to access training content and participate in learning activities through web browsers, eliminating the need for physical classrooms or face-to-face interactions.

g. L&D Protocols - These are established procedures and guidelines within the Learning and Development (L&D) department.

h. Competency Framework - Also known as competency matrix, is a tool used by organizations to assess and manage the skills, competencies, and proficiency levels of their workforce.

5 Responsibilities

a. The L&D Head is responsible for:

- Leading and coordinating the L&D function in the organization.
- Conducting or overseeing the L&D needs analysis at the organizational, departmental, and individual levels.
- Developing or approving the annual L&D plan based on the L&D needs analysis and the organizational strategy.
- Allocating or securing the budget and resources for L&D activities.
- Implementing or supervising the implementation of the L&D plan.

- Evaluating or ensuring the evaluation of the L&D plan.
- Reporting or ensuring the reporting of the L&D plan to the senior management and other stakeholders.
- Reviewing and updating the L&D policies, procedures and practices as needed.

a. L&D Operations is responsible for:

- Supporting and participating in the L&D needs analysis for their departments and staff members.
- Providing input and feedback on the L&D plan development and implementation.
- Allocating or facilitating the time and resources for their staff members to attend or conduct L&D activities.
- Monitoring and supporting their staff members' learning progress and performance improvement.
- Providing input and feedback on the training evaluation and reporting.

6 RACI

Process	Responsible	Accountable	Consulted	Informed
Identify/Qualify Training Requirement	PM/Department Manager	Department Head	PM/HRH	Department Head/HRH
Organizing Training	L&D – Operations	L&DH	Vendor/Department Head	HRH/Department Head/PM/Department Manager
Vendor Management	L&D – Operations	L&DH	Vendor/Department Head	HRH
L&D Protocol	L&D – Operations	L&DH	HRH/Department Head	HRH/Department Head/ PM/Department Manager

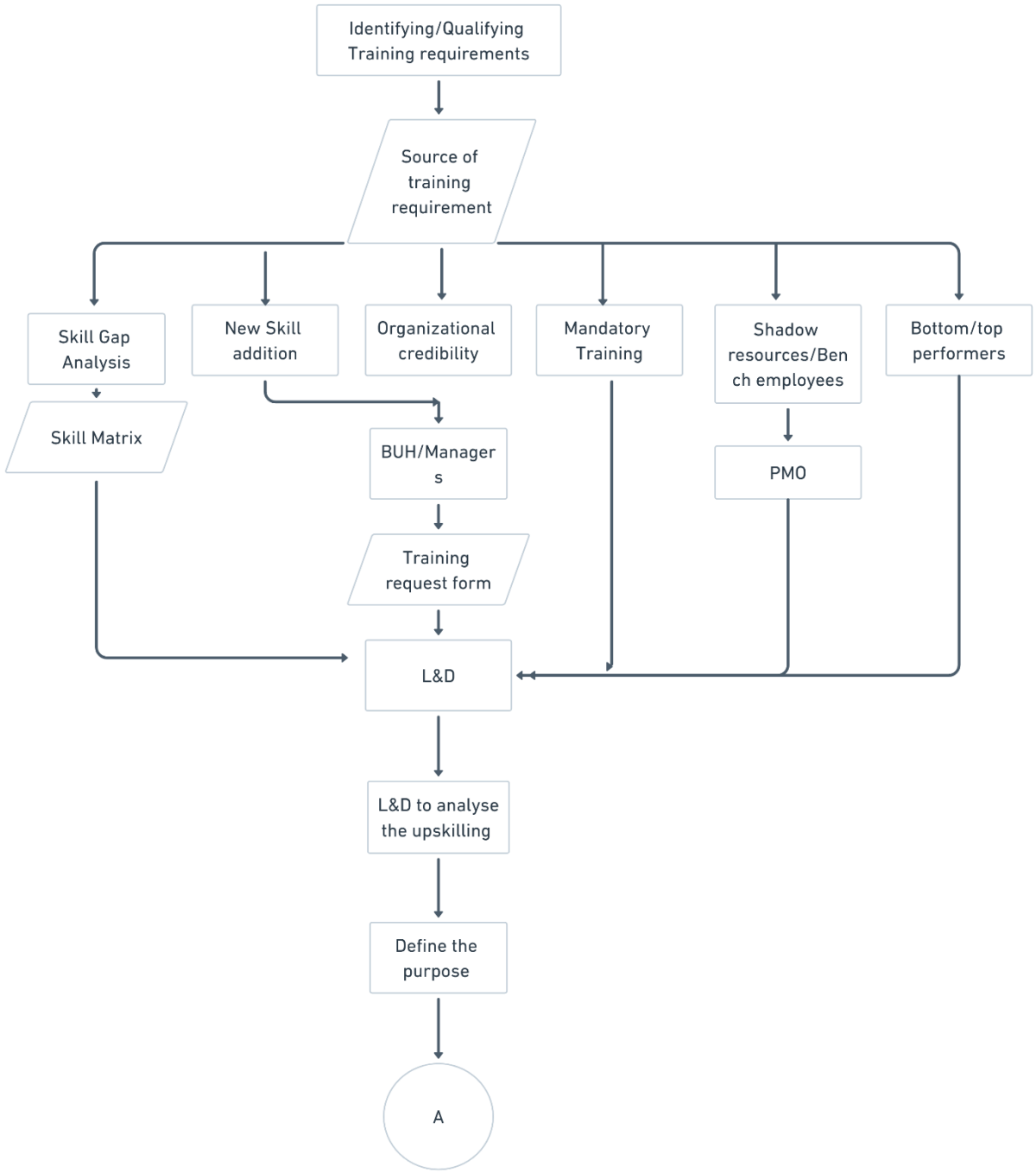
7 SIPOC

Supplier	Input	Process and Control		Output	Customer
		Process	Control		

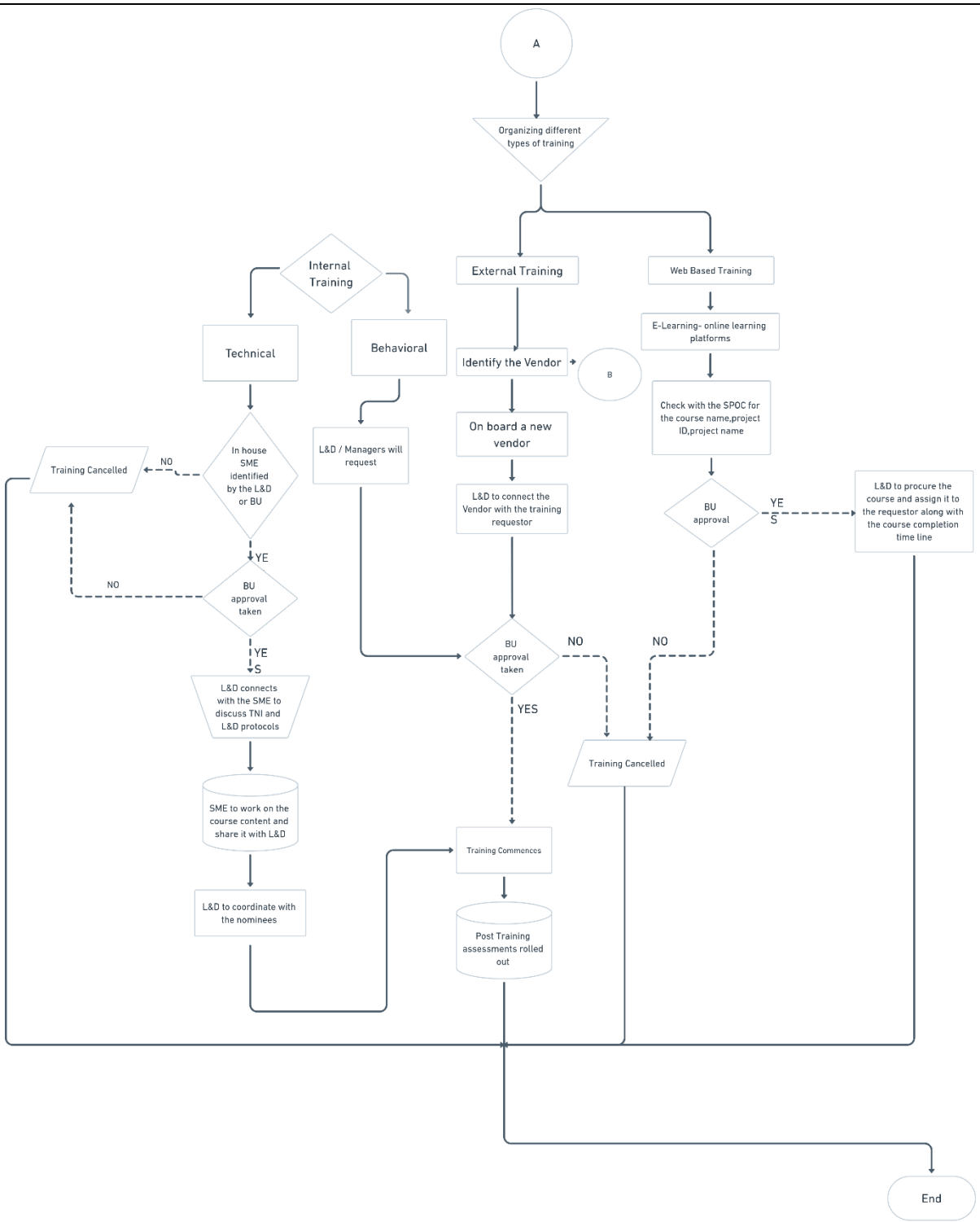
Respective Projects / Functions	Learning need identification	Learning and Development	Training effectiveness assessment	Trained Resources	Respective Projects / Functions

8 Overall Process Flow Chart

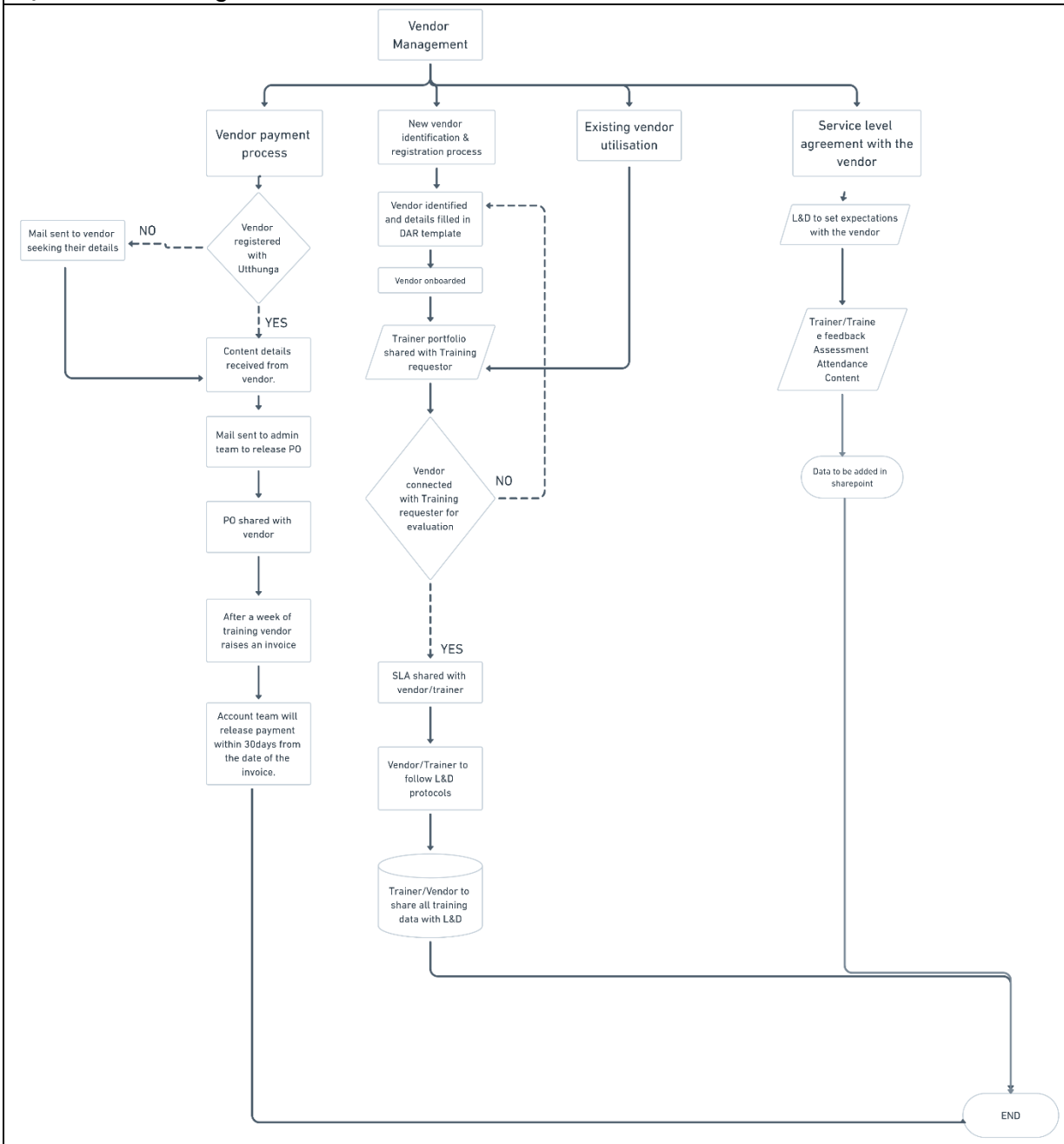
a) Identifying Training Requirements



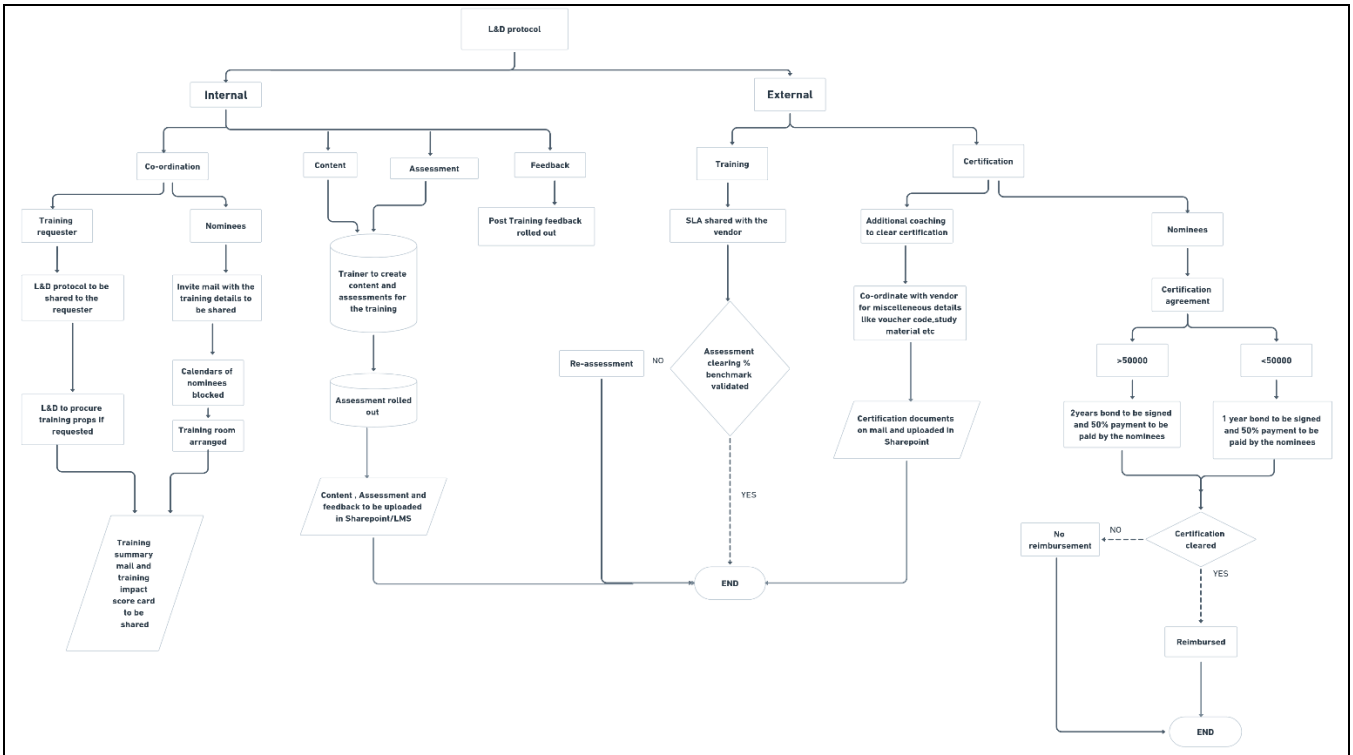
b) Organizing different types of Training


A
Organizing different types of training
Internal Training
External Training
Web Based Training
Technical
Behavioral
Identify the Vendor
B
E-Learning- online learning platforms
Check with the SPOC for the course name,project ID,project name
On board a new vendor
L&D / Managers will request
In house SME identified by the L&D or BU
NO
Training Cancelled
L&D to connect the Vendor with the training requestor
BU approval
YES
L&D to procure the course and assign it to the requestor along with the course completion time line
YE
NO
BU approval taken
YE
S
BU approval taken
NO
NO
YES
L&D connects with the SME to discuss TNI and L&D protocols
Training Cancelled
SME to work on the course content and share it with L&D
Training Commences
L&D to coordinate with the nominees
Post Training assessments rolled out
End

c) Vendor Management



d) L&D Protocol


L&D protocol
Internal
External
Co-ordination
Content
Assessment
Feedback
Training
Certification
Training requester
Nominees
Post Training feedback rolled out
SLA shared with the vendor
Additional coaching to clear certification
Nominees
L&D protocol to be shared to the requester
Invite mail with the training details to be shared
Trainer to create content and assessments for the training
Co-ordinate with vendor for miscelleneous details like voucher code,study material etc
Certification agreement
Re-assessment
NO
Assessment clearing % benchmark validated
>50000
<50000
Calendars of nominees blocked
Assessment rolled out
Certification documents on mail and uploaded in Sharepoint
2years bond to be signed and 50% payment to be paid by the nominees
1 year bond to be signed and 50% payment to be paid by the nominees
L&D to procure training props if requested
Training room arranged
YES
Content , Assessment and feedback to be uploaded in Sharepoint/LMS
No reimbursement
NO
Certification cleared
YES
Training summary mail and training impact score card to be shared
END
Reimbursed
END

9 Process Description

9.1 Identifying Training Requirements

All Training Programs shall be planned, conducted and progress tracked against the plan created at the beginning of each quarter/month. The same is measured and analyzed.

9.2 Training for existing Employees

Training requirements are based on the following:

Skill gap analysis activity conducted by L&D shall be one of the sources to identify the training needs. Another source for training needs will be sent by BUHs for their respective unit based on the business projection for the respective year.

Training requests shall be shared for the below-mentioned criteria.

a. New Skill addition

b. Organizational/Department credibility Upgrade.

c. Mandatory Training course for all the employees.

d. Upskilling the bench employees with the necessary skills required for potential.

9.3 Training for New Joiners

New Joiners shall be trained as per the defined training path that aligns with the organization's values, work culture and enables them to perform their roles and responsibilities. Training coverage will include the below aspects:

a. Environment Health Safety Training

b. QMS Training

c. Code of Conduct

d. Industrial Automation Segment

9.4 Training Need Analysis

Skill Matrix shall be used as a primary source document to identify the skill gap amongst the existing employees.

a. It includes details of employee skills based on the current role and their expertise.

b. The result of comparison of the required level of expertise/skills versus the current expertise/skills will be defined as the skill gap of that employee.

c. Employee skills shall be updated with a frequency of once a year before the appraisal cycle.

d. L&D will be the custodian of the skill matrix document and in-charge of maintaining the document in the current state.

BU requirements for Skill Addition

a. Project Managers or BUHs shall be initiating and overseeing the process of identifying training requirement for the team members in the below scenarios:

b. New Project Acquisition

c. New Requirement for existing project

d. The project Managers or BUH's shall collaborate with L&D and provide inputs on department specific training needs in the beginning of every year.

- Prioritize the identified training needs based on business urgency and importance. Some needs may be critical for immediate performance improvement, while others may be long-term developmental goals.
- The training planned for the year will be listed in the Training Calendar and published at org level and employees can also register for the same.
- The trainings are marked as priority in the form of – P1, P2, P3 & P4 for that quarter and the trainings will be planned, organized, and executed accordingly.
- If the Priority is not shared by the BUH, L&D coordinator to follow up and get the priority listed.

9.5 Organizing Different Types of Training

a. Internal Training Procedure

- The training will be identified based on the business requirement and the L&D will start organizing the training 10 - 15 days prior to the scheduled date.
- The trainer to be identified by L&D/BUH and the training coordinator will notify him/her about the requirement amongst the list of SMEs.
- If the trainer is from the same BU- the training coordinator to connect with the trainer directly to take consensus on the objective and expected outcome (TNI).
- The training coordinator will set expectations on the L&D protocols to be followed to the trainer and the trainer will have to submit to L&D within 2 workings days after the training completion date.
- The training coordinator will validate the document and upload it in the Sharepoint folder.
- The training coordinator will block the calendar of the participants 5 - 10 days before the training scheduled date based on the urgency level of the requirement.
- The same learning document can be used for web based self-learning for future requirements. In scenarios, when there are <2 employees for training. Wherein the SME need not involve but the content will be assigned for self-

learning and there will be a discussion-based session with the SME for limited hours to clarify questions with the trainees.

b. External Training Procedure

- L&D to identify the vendor by following the parameters from the DAR template.
- Training requirements shall be shared with the vendor. On acceptance to fulfill the training requirement, the vendor will share the following details with L&D:
  - Training Course Outline
  - Training Duration
  - Quotation of the training
  - Trainer availability dates
- Post evaluation with 2-3 vendors the details to be shared with procurement/admin team to evaluate the cost and vendor.
- L&D will share the above details with the BU, post BU approval L&D will schedule a connect between the Vendor trainer and if required, another internal stake holders/BU will be included.
- L&D will identify suitable training vendors and share their details with the Procurement team for further processing, including cost evaluation, negotiation, and final selection. If the proposed vendor is not registered with Utthunga, the Procurement team shall initiate the onboarding process through the ERP Next tool.
- BU to evaluate the trainer and share their consent on email and then the booking will be considered as confirmed. The BU to fill the Trainer Evaluation Form and share with L&D.
- Post the vendor acknowledgement, the payment shall be processed by the procurement team. As per the payments terms the amount will be processed within 45-60 working days from the PO issuance date.
- If the trainer is not pro-active in sharing critical and common observations at regular intervals of the training giving sufficient time for L&D to act, then the observations will not be valid.
- If the training outcome is not meeting the SLAs that were agreed upon, the vendor should conduct re-training and assess the participants again.
- L&D will upload the training data into Sharepoint folder for data analysis.

c. Web Based Training

- L&D to identify the effective training mode which can be subjective to the topic, if the training mode is online or web based then the training requestor will have to confirm the course to be procured for learning with the training coordinator.
- Training coordinator will be accountable to complete the procurement process within 3 - 5 working days from the request date.

  What if any issues:

  - Online portal Issue – The training coordinator to work with the Online platform technical team and to keep all the stake holders in an email communication loop and update the TAT for resolution.
  - Issue with the Accounts - The training coordinator to work with the Accounts team and to keep all the stake holders in an email communication loop and update the TAT for resolution.

9.6 Vendor Management

a. Vendor registration Process

- Any Institute that qualifies to fulfill Utthunga' s training needs will be registered as a vendor DAR Template is used to qualify a vendor before deciding to make any transactions with them. Registration process is mandatory for the vendor to work with Utthunga. Below are details the vendor must share for registration:
  - PAN card
  - GST Certificate (not applicable for freelancers)
  - TDS form to be filled.
  - Registration form to be filled.
  - Cancelled Cheque
- L&D to update the above details in vendor tracker and share the same with the Procurement team for the vendor details to be upload in our system, then the vendor will be declared as registered.
- Utthunga can choose to change vendors for any requirement at any given period if the outcomes are not meeting as defined in the SLA. Exception, if any periodical agreement signed up between the two parties (Utthunga and Vendor).

b. Vendor Payment process

- Training cost to be shared by the vendor which will be sent for BU/Training requester approval.

- Post Training, vendor will share the invoice with L&D which will be saved in L&D SharePoint for tracking and shared with the accounts team who will process the payment.
- The below clause shall be explained at the time of signing up with the vendor:
- Accounts team will take about 45-60 business days to release the payment from the invoice date and the same shall be communicated to the vendor at the time of signing up for the training.
- Every vendor will be liable for 10% of TDS deduction which is applicable for transaction in the given financial year.
- Vendor without PAN/GST/TDS/ refusing the tax deductions shall not be registered with Utthunga.
- Once the payment is transferred to the vendor, accounts team to share the payment confirmation with L&D and the same is sent to the vendor on mail and acknowledgment on payment receipt is taken.

9.7 L&D Protocol

a. Training requests shall be raised by BUHs/managers and submitted through Training Request Form with the training objective and expected outcome.

b. The training shall be scheduled by L&D and the process of scheduling will vary depending on the type of training. Training can be either Internal, external or web based. Trainings will be organized by L&D based on set procedures of coordination.

c. The Assigned trainer will have to follow the L&D protocol and share the required training execution data with L&D on completion of the training.

d. Initial communication regarding the training is sent to all employees in advance to ensure adequate planning and to minimize last-minute dropouts. In the event an employee is unable to attend due to a genuine reason, they are required to formally request withdrawal via email, clearly stating the reason and looping in their reporting manager.

e. Failure to follow the withdrawal process will render the employee liable to bear the training cost, as per the participant cost communicated in the prior email.

9.8 Training Effectiveness

a. The training efficiency shall be measured based on the data captured during the training execution and the evaluated outcome. Below are the L&D Protocols that help measure effectiveness:

- Attendance
- Pre & Post Training Assessment
- Trainee Feedback

9.9 Induction and Orientation

HR Ops spoc will coordinate with new joiners and share invite for the induction sessions along with the directions, instructions, responsible person to contact and loop L&D team in the communication as the Pre & Post the session tracking will be stored in L&D data tracker.

9.10 Waiver/Defaulter in a Training Program

a. Defaulting in attending Trainings:

- The trainee must notify the training coordinator of his/her absence well in advance through email looping his/her manager. The trainee can miss the training only if he/she has medical emergency. If the trainee fails to notify the training coordinator of his/her absence, disciplinary action will be taken and will not be considered for other trainings.

b. Defaulting in clearing assessments

- The trainees will be given assessments post the session and trainees should appropriately answer the questions based on their learning from the session.
- The trainee to submit the response immediately after the session.
- The trainee should clear the assessment with >=70% to be marked as passed or certified.
- If the trainee fails to clear the assessment, he/she will have to retake the assessment again. Only 2 attempts will be allowed, if the trainee does not clear the assessment, the same will be notified to the BU heads and respective managers.
- If the trainee does not take up the assessments disciplinary action will be taken and will not be considered for other trainings. The same will also be notified to the BU heads and respective managers.

9.11 Certifications

a. Employees who undergo training programs and receive certifications that contribute to their individual growth and skill enhancement, while also representing the credibility of the organization—are considered beneficiaries of organizational investment.

b. Employees availing such training and certification opportunities are mandatorily required to sign a legal agreement with the organization, outlining the terms of commitment.

c. Employees who do not agree to the stated terms and conditions or refuse to sign the mandatory agreement shall not be eligible to participate in the certification process. In such cases, the employee will be excluded from the

training certification program, and no certification shall be issued or recognized under organizational records.

d. Initially, Employee pays for his/her certification/course, completes the exam, and thereafter produces the certificate of completion which would be reviewed, and the examination fees would be completely refunded by Employer for certification/training cost.

e. The Employer pays 100% of the training and certification fees for the Employee thereafter, the Employee takes the exam, clears, and agrees to the terms and conditions, and signs the Agreement.

f. In cases where the certification cost is ₹10,000 or below, the employee shall be required to sign a legal agreement committing to a minimum service period of one (1) year from the date of certification.

g. In cases where the certification cost exceeds ₹50,000, the employee shall be required to sign a legal agreement committing to a minimum service period of two (2) years from the date of certification. This ensures appropriate return on investment and alignment with organizational learning and development objectives.

h. In the event the employee fails to clear the certification examination, the terms of the signed agreement shall remain in effect. The employee will be required to retake the examination as per the conditions specified, and the service commitment period shall continue to apply from the date of initial certification attempt.

i. If the certification examination permits only a single attempt and the employee fails to clear it, 50% of the amount paid by the employee towards the certification shall not be reimbursed. The employee shall continue to remain bound by the terms of the signed agreement for the defined service period.

9.12 Risk Assessment

Risk Assessment is ongoing activity which will be conducted quarterly, and the details shall be captured in Risk Assessment form. The Risk Assessment shall involve.

a. Identifying the Risk

b. Plan a Mitigation for the identified Risk.

c. Contingency plan for Identified Risk

d. Re-assess the risk on quarterly basis.

9.13 Configuration Management

a. Configuration Area/Directory Structure

- All the documents related to Quality Management System shall be in Share point source control.
- All the L&D operation's documents will be saved in the Share point folder in a sequential order.
- The documents older than a year will be saved in old documents folder.

b. Configurable item list

- A Master list will be prepared in which all the L&D operational documents will be available in a sequential format as available in the share point folder. This document will be updated based.

10 Information Security requirements

a. **Data Protection:**

All personal and sensitive information related to employees, trainees, and training materials will be securely stored and handled according to relevant data protection laws in the organizational policies.

Access to training records and personal data will be restricted to HR Head and L&D members only.

b. Confidentiality:

- Confidential information, including training content and employee performance data, will not be disclosed to unauthorized individuals or parties.
- Non-disclosure agreements (NDAs) will be used where appropriate to ensure confidentiality.

c. Secure Communication:

- All communication channels used for training purposes (e.g., emails, messaging platforms) will be secure and encrypted wherever required.
- The training materials shared electronically will be within the Utthunga network only.

d. Access Control:

- Role-based access controls (RBAC) to restrict access to training systems and data based on the user's role and necessity.
- L&D will review and update access permissions to reflect changes in roles or employment status as and when there are changes in the team members.

11 References

a. ISO 9001 Clauses 7.1.6, 7.2,7.3
b. ISO 27001 Clauses 7.1, 8.1 Controls A6, A7
c. ISMS Control Policies Related to Human Resources Security

d. Skill Matrix -Guideline UT/SF/LDP/GDL/01
e. Learning & Development handbook UT/SF/LDP/GDL/02

12 L&D Metrics

a. Training Planned Vs Conducted
b. Training Attendance%
c. Post Training Effectiveness
d. Post Training Assessment
e. Post Training Feedback
f. L&D to drive per employee learning hours and the target is taken at the beginning of every year.

13 Annexures

NA

14 Forms

a. Training Request Form
b. Pre-observations
c. Attendance
d. Post Training Assessment
e. Trainer Feedback Template
f. Training Presentation Template
g. DAR template
h. Vendor registration
i. Vendor tracker